JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Principal Engineer with 12 years in infrastructure and cloud architecture. Started my career as a Graduate Software Developer straight out of university and moved into a Principal Engineer role managing enterprise-wide technical strategy across multiple business units. I have a genuine passion for solving complex distributed systems problems and mentoring junior engineers through their career progression. Outside of work, I enjoy hiking in North Wales and restoring vintage motorcycles.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer - Nexus Cloud Solutions

nexus-cloud.io

Liverpool, United Kingdom

June 2022 - Present

Led architectural redesign of core microservices infrastructure serving 150+ microservices across three data centres, reducing deployment time by 65 percent and improving system reliability to 99.98 percent uptime.

Managed a team of 18 senior engineers and architects, overseeing technical hiring, performance reviews, and career development planning across both Liverpool and Manchester offices.

Established cloud migration strategy for legacy monolithic applications, resulting in successful transition of 45 legacy systems to Kubernetes clusters with zero downtime migrations.

Implemented comprehensive observability platform using Prometheus and Grafana, providing real-time monitoring dashboards that decreased mean time to resolution by 42 percent across all production incidents.

Senior Infrastructure Engineer - DataFlow Technologies Ltd

dataflow-tech.net

Liverpool, United Kingdom

January 2021 - May 2022

Architected and deployed containerized platform supporting 200+ concurrent microservices with automated scaling policies and load balancing across multi-region AWS infrastructure.

Designed disaster recovery procedures and automated backup strategies that achieved RPO of 1 hour and RTO of 4 hours for all mission-critical systems.

Optimised database query performance through index analysis and query rewriting, improving application response times by 58 percent for customer-facing APIs.

Conducted security audits and vulnerability assessments, implementing container image scanning and runtime security monitoring using Falco and OPA policies.

Graduate Software Developer - Capgemini

www.capgemini.com

Liverpool, United Kingdom

September 2012 - December 2020

Developed full-stack applications using Java and Spring Framework for FTSE 100 financial services clients in agile delivery teams of 6-8 developers.

Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitLab, automating deployment processes to development, staging, and production environments across multiple projects.

Contributed to enterprise architecture decisions and technology selection for microservices-based platform supporting 2 million daily active users.

Participated in on-call rotations managing production incident response and post-incident reviews, achieving 99.5 percent service level agreement compliance.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Manchester

Graduated: June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud Platform, Microsoft Azure

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Docker Swarm, Helm

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Vagrant

Programming Languages: Java, Python, Go, Bash, SQL

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis

CI/CD Tools: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, CircleCI

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, Load Balancing, VPC Architecture, SSL/TLS

Security: Container Security, IAM Policies, Secrets Management, OWASP Top 10